

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1028

By Wright

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Carol Mitchell upon being selected as the National Federation of State High School Associations' 2025 National Softball Coach of the Year.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to pay tribute to those excellent coaches who have led their players to success in athletic competition and in life; and

WHEREAS, since becoming head softball coach in 1993, Coach Carol Mitchell has established herself as an institution at Gibbs High School and guided the program to unprecedented heights of achievement; and

WHEREAS, Coach Mitchell was recently named the 2025 National Softball Coach of the Year by the National Federation of State High School Associations (NFHS), an honor most befitting her singular record of achievement as a coach; and

WHEREAS, Carol Mitchell is the winningest high school softball coach in Tennessee history, with a record of 1,103-321-4 over thirty-two seasons; she ranks in the top five in the nation in wins among active high school softball coaches; and

WHEREAS, Coach Mitchell has led the Gibbs Lady Eagles to seven state championships, including a "three-peat" in 1998-2000 and back-to-back titles in 2024 and 2025; her team has finished runner-up in state tournament play four times, won twenty-one regional championships, and taken home twenty-nine district championships; and

WHEREAS, in addition to being the NFHS 2025 National Softball Coach of the Year, Coach Mitchell was named the Tennessee Secondary School Athletic Association (TSSAA) 2025 Coach of the Year; and

WHEREAS, over the years, she has been honored as Knoxville Prep Coach of the Year, Tennessee Coach of the Year, and Southeast Sectional Coach of the Year; received a distinguished service award from TSSAA; and garnered the A.F. Bridges Award; and

WHEREAS, she has been inducted into the Greater Knoxville Sports Hall of Fame (2003), the South Atlantic Conference Hall of Fame (2007), the Carson-Newman University Athletics Hall of Fame (2009), and the Tennessee Softball Coach Hall of Fame (2016); and

WHEREAS, Coach Mitchell is a 1987 graduate of Gibbs High School and played on the school's first four state championship softball teams; she attended Carson-Newman University, where she was a dominating softball pitcher and amassed 123 wins with an overall ERA of 1.14 and a senior-year ERA of .91; and

WHEREAS, Carol Mitchell has distinguished herself as a great coach, tactician, and motivator of young athletes, and we are pleased to recognize her on this most noteworthy occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Carol Mitchell upon being selected as the National Federation of State High School Associations' 2025 National Softball Coach of the Year, extending our best wishes for every continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.